

Denis Kazhekin

Data Scientist · NLP / LLM

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SUMMARY

Data Scientist with 2+ years in NLP for banking products (Alfa-Bank, Sber): guardrail classifiers for LLM assistants, intent classifiers for chat and voice bots, LLM-workflow systems. I take models to production end to end, from problem framing and annotation to threshold calibration against the business objective.

EXPERIENCE

Alfa-Bank — Data Scientist

May 2026 – Present

Language Models Development Directorate (formerly NLP Center of Excellence), guardrail module team for the LLM hub

- Scaled inference throughput of the guardrail classifier inside the bank's perimeter from 35 to 4,500 RPS ($\times 128$) under a $p95 \leq 500$ ms SLA: bottleneck profiling, engine comparison (MLServer, TEI, Triton, vLLM) and configuration tuning.
- Ran a series of training experiments for the 23-class guardrail classifier on encoder and decoder backbones: full fine-tuning, LoRA, few-shot with demonstrations from the training set, domain-adaptive pretraining on a large corpus; the best configuration gained +2 pp PR-AUC on the binary decision and +3 pp mAP on the multi-class decision.
- Designed the decision-rule methodology: built a Pareto curve of final quality across threshold-selection techniques under the given constraints to maximize the resulting effect.
- Formalized the model delivery process from development to release.

Sber — Data Scientist

Nov 2025 – May 2026

Proactive Customer Profile team, Digital Twin (B2C)

- Redesigned the architecture of two LLM-workflow systems: proactive-question trigger detection quality improved by 10 pp, request-category classification by 5 pp.
- Built an end-to-end quality-evaluation cycle for production ML pipelines: business-problem decomposition, target-metric selection, data-collection design, annotator guidelines and training, final measurement and validation.

Alfa-Bank — Data Scientist

Jun 2024 – Oct 2025

Machine Learning Lab, NLP Center of Excellence, chat and voice bots team

- Built and shipped a context-aware intent classifier for the retail chatbot: +1.1 pp correctly resolved sessions, +3 pp over the previous model's quality metric.
- Shipped an intent classifier for the retail voice bot: +15 pp over the previous model's metric.
- Built a context-aware intent classifier for the SME chatbot (estimated impact: +3.7 pp share of automated dialogues).
- Built an end-of-dialogue detector for a dynamic customer-satisfaction survey window (estimated impact: +0.2 points on the feedback score).
- Piloted a model detecting causes of customer negativity, cutting manual dialogue review by bot scenario writers.
- Team contribution over the period: +2.3 pp share of automated dialogues and +0.1 points on the feedback score in the retail chatbot.

EDUCATION

ITMO University — M.Sc., AI Talent Hub

2025 – 2027 (expected)

Online

Moscow Aviation Institute (MAI) — B.Sc.

2021 – 2025

Computer Technologies and Applied Mathematics, full-time

Additional: Avito Analytics Academy (DS track), Deep Learning School (MIPT).

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Winner, VK $\times$ HSE Data Hack.
- 4th place, MTS case, V International Aviation Hackathon (MAI).
- Participant, Yandex $\times$ HSE Machine Learning Student Camp.

SKILLS

Languages	Python, SQL, C/C++
ML / NLP	PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, scikit-learn; classical ML, NLP (BERT-family encoders, LLMs, LLM workflows), CV, Audio
Infrastructure	MLflow, Apache Airflow, Docker, Streamlit, Git, Linux, vLLM, Jenkins
Spoken	Russian — native; English — B2